

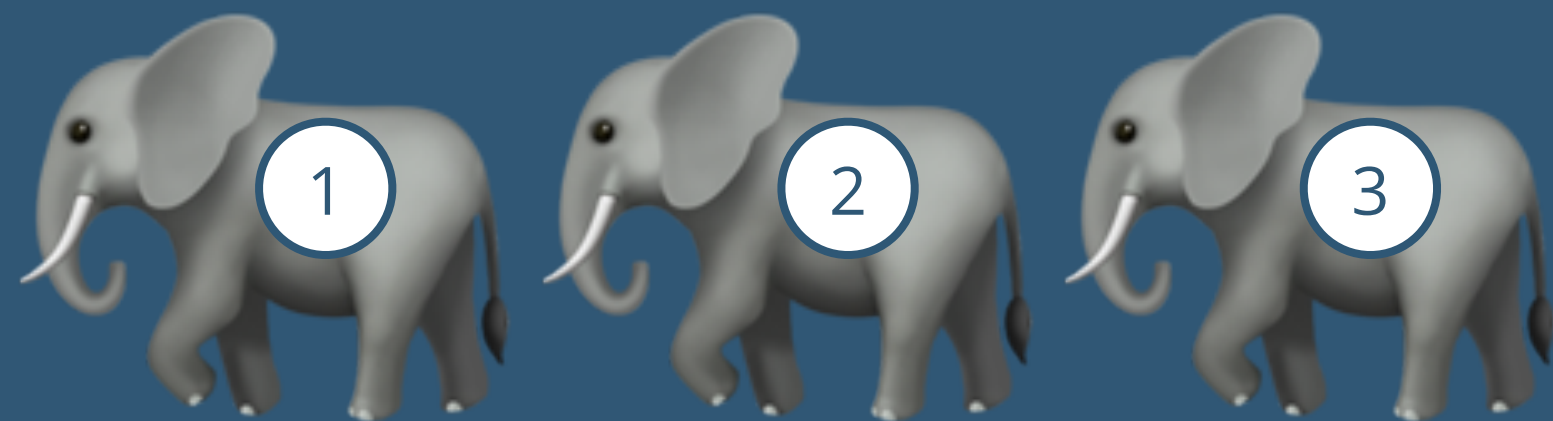


Beyond the basics

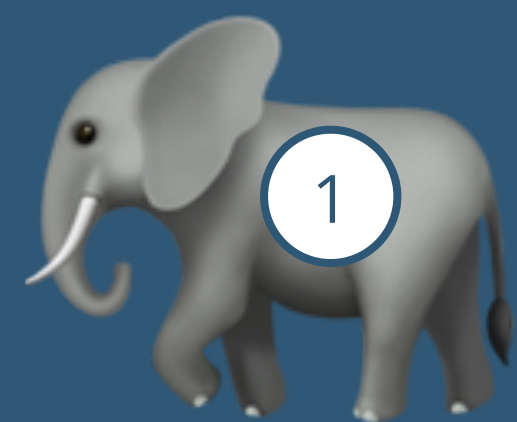
Part of the "Getting Started with Positron" workshop

Posit Software, PBC





in the room



: Python

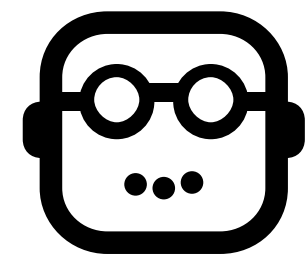


R and Python, not R or Python

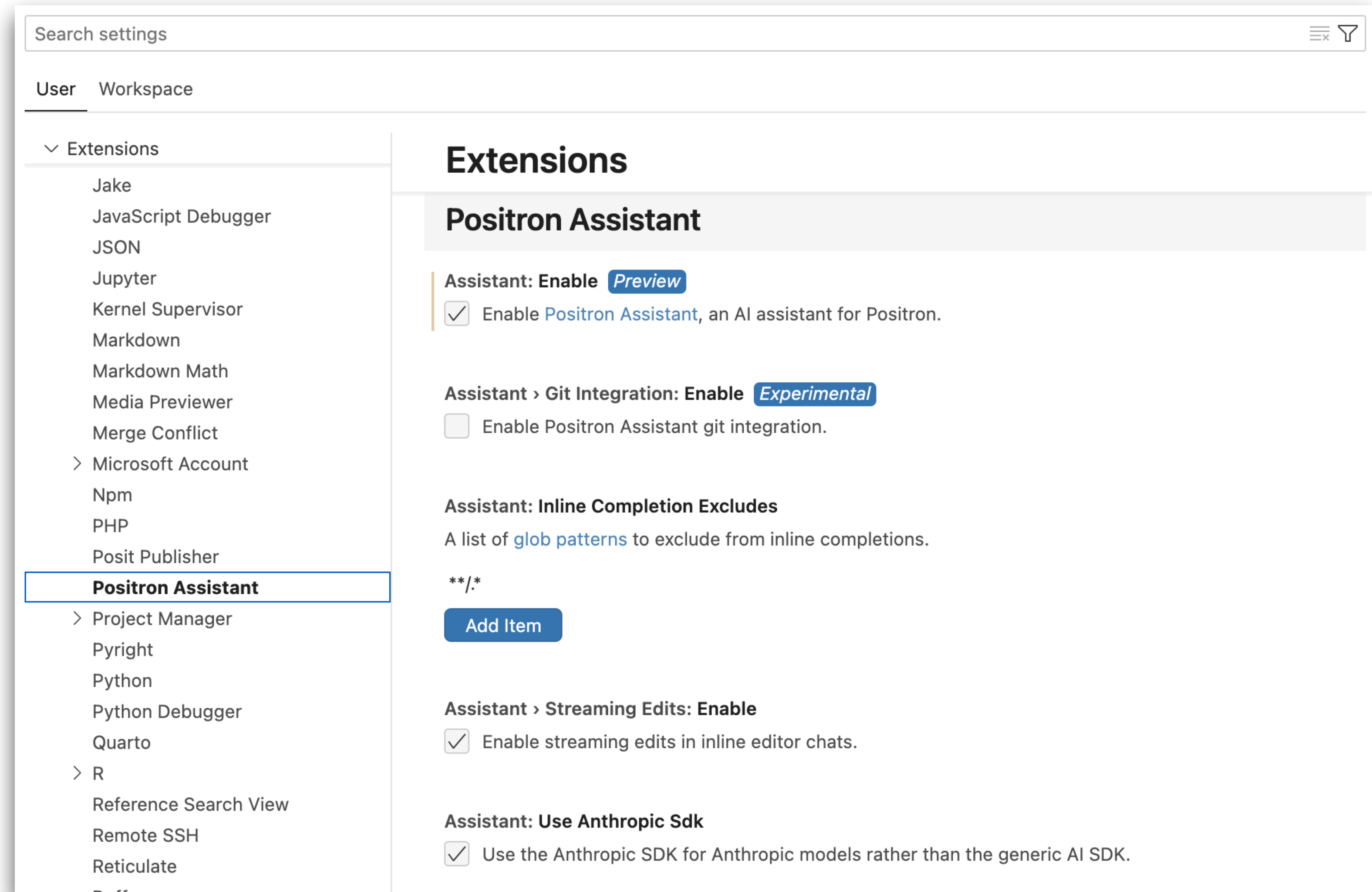
- Difficult: Getting used to and feeling productive in different IDEs
- Feels easier: Learning a second language or being multi-lingual in the same IDE



What about AI?



Positron Assistant
is an AI client that
provides LLM integration
within Positron, both for
chat and for inline
completions.



<https://positron.posit.co/assistant.html>

Positron Assistant > Chat interface

Once enabled,
Positron
Assistant is
accessible from
the sidebar

The screenshot displays the Positron IDE interface. On the left sidebar, the 'CHAT' panel is active, showing a chat window with the 'Anthropic' model selected. The chat content includes instructions on how to create a new R script and add code to it. A red box highlights the 'Add Context...' button in the chat panel. An orange arrow points from this button to the code editor. The code editor shows an R script with the following code:

```
1 library(tidyverse)
2
3 # Read the fruits.csv file using readr
4 fruits <- read_csv("fruit.csv")
5
6 # Check the structure and preview the data
7 glimpse(fruits)
8 fruits
```

The right sidebar shows the 'SESSION' panel with the 'VARIABLES' tab selected, indicating that no variables have been created. The bottom panel shows the 'CONSOLE' tab with the following output:

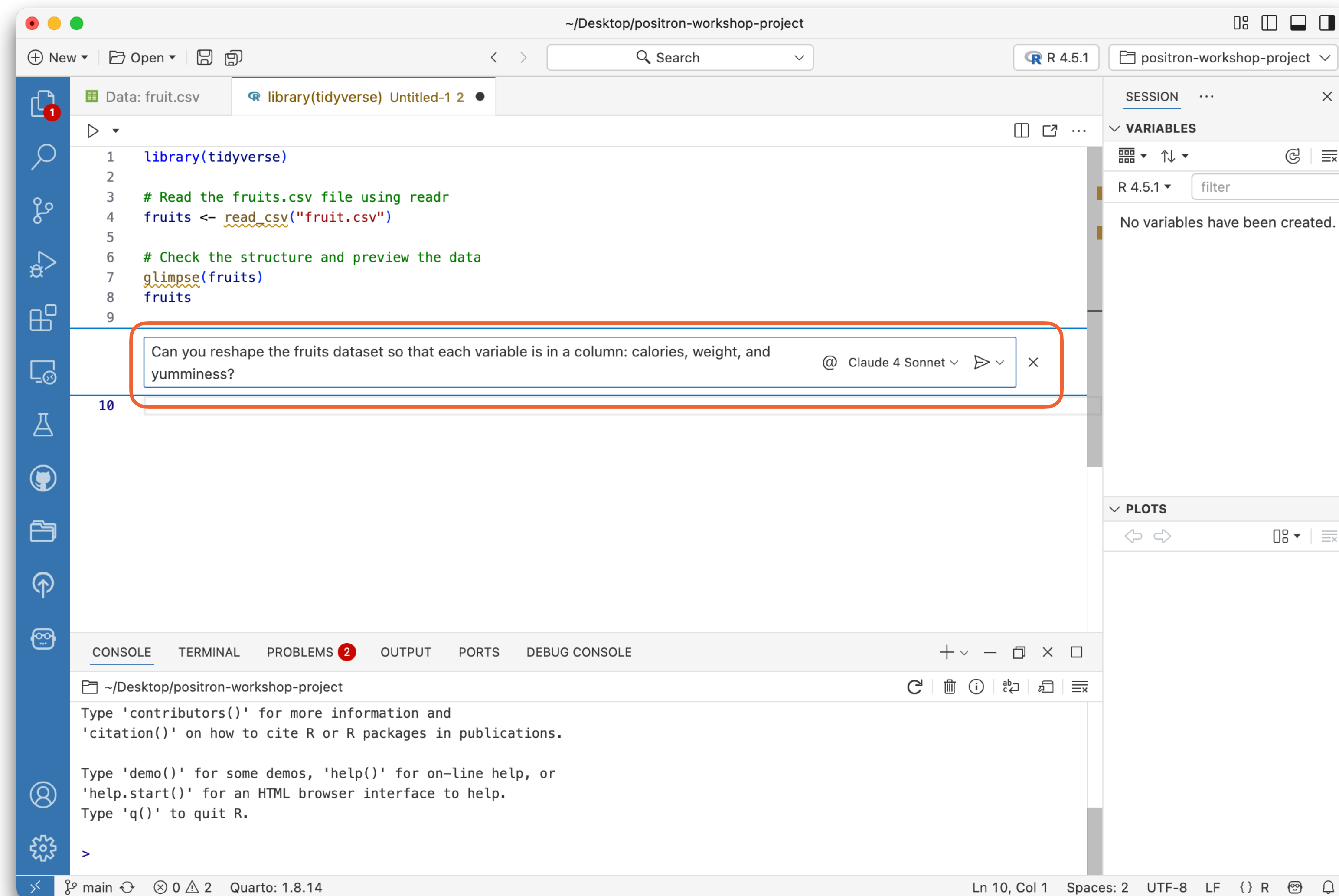
```
~/Desktop/positron-workshop-project
Type 'contributors()' for more information and
'citation()' on how to cite R or R packages in publications.

Type 'demo()' for some demos, 'help()' for on-line help, or
'help.start()' for an HTML browser interface to help.
Type 'q()' to quit R.

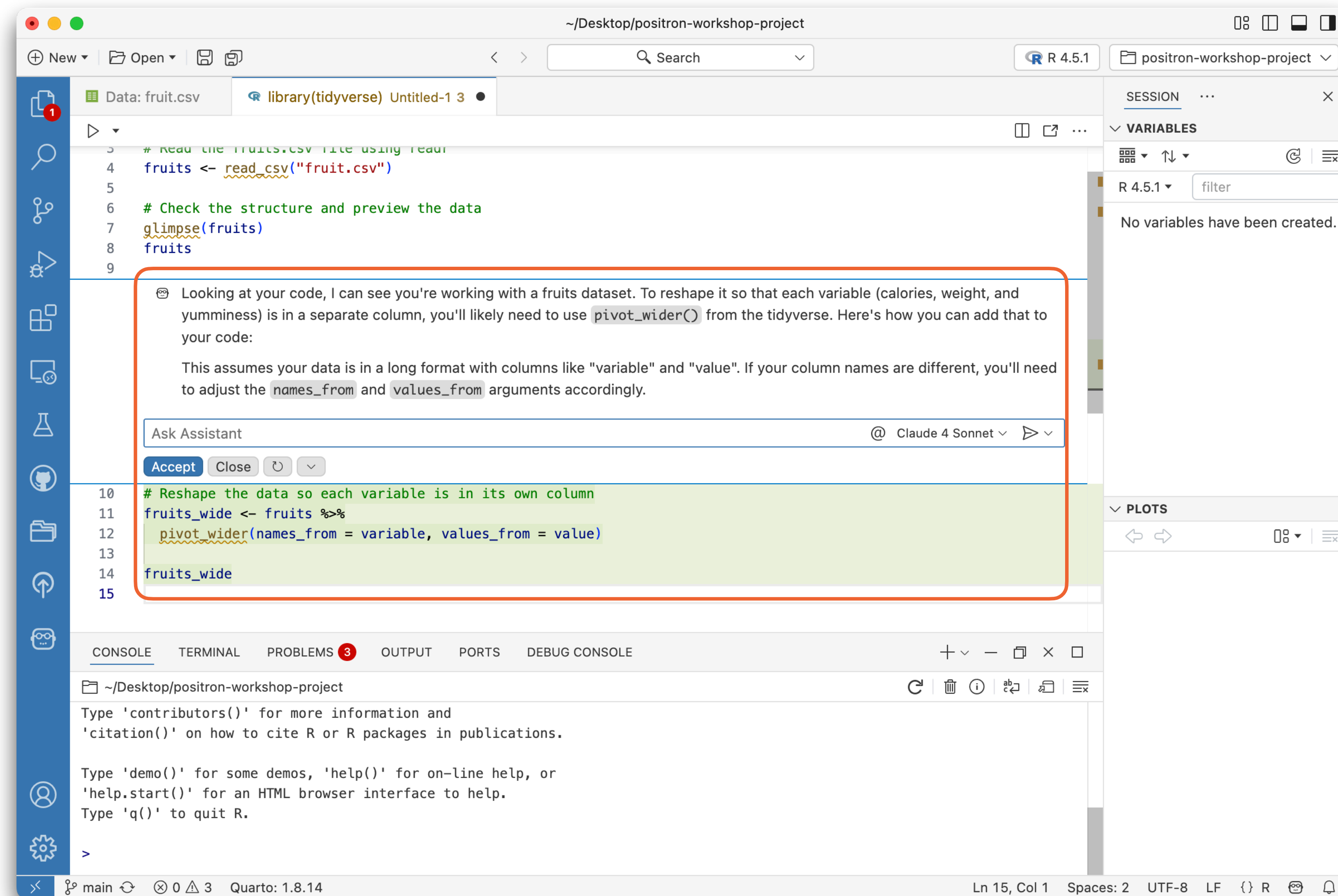
>
```

The status bar at the bottom indicates the current file is 'main', the project is 'positron-workshop-project', and the version of Quarto is 1.8.14. The console shows the current line is 8, column 7, with 2 spaces, UTF-8 encoding, and LF line endings.

Positron Assistant > Inline completions

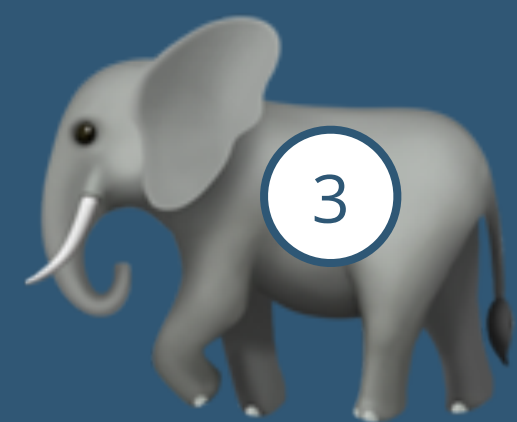


Positron Assistant > Inline completions



Good (I think) practices for using AI tools

- Start with iterative development through the chat interface instead of inline completions
- Current support for language model providers (this will expand in future):
 - Chat: Anthropic Claude only (at this time) — User must bring their own API key.
 - Inline: GitHub Copilot available — User will need to have a GitHub account with Copilot enabled.



: RStudio 

Is RStudio going away?

- No, but “we intend to prioritize security, stability, priority bug fixes, and targeted improvements over an emphasis on sweeping novel feature development” and “bulk of large-scale, new features will go into Positron”.
- We recommend starting with Positron for those who don’t have prior R or RStudio experience, but Positron doesn’t yet have the full set of options that RStudio does for “teaching in the browser” — it’s on the near-term roadmap though!

Positron vs. RStudio

Some R-focused features will remain exclusive to RStudio:

- RStudio has deeper support for Sweave and R Markdown vs. can render R Markdown in Positron but targeted focus is on Quarto.
- No inline output for source documents in Positron, but:
 - actively enhancing our Positron-native notebook UI that will provide inline outputs for R or Python sessions
 - working on improving Quarto's Visual Editor to improve the authoring experience for Quarto
- RStudio is extensible only via RStudio add-ins vs. not all add-ins are supported in but many more extensions are available

Wrap-up

Keeping up-to-date

- Positron will automatically update
 - Setting: *Update > Positron: Channel*
 - **releases**: stable, monthly-ish releases, same version as on download page.
 - **dailies**: ~every day, cutting edge

Getting help

- Positron Docs: <https://positron.posit.co/>
- Ask questions on GitHub discussions: <https://github.com/posit-dev/positron/discussions>

Q&A